Nickolas Diaz

Dr. Patrick Luck

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Response for the Affluent Society

This discussion will talk about the shock of Russians from viewing American life and the shock of Americans from what other countries don't have from the text of "Richard Nixon on the American Standard of Living". To start off Richard Nixon explains what is in the American exhibition in Moscow, saying that the houses, cars, and TV displayed there are affordable to the common American. In Russian society the same items can only be obtained by the rich, to them it would seem unbelievable and quite a shock to hear that, they probably think it is propaganda for the US. From the American perspective, they don't realise that many other countries cannot afford the same luxuries, even something as simple as a car. They would be shocked to hear that other countries would call them rich in their societies. Nixon also points out several social programs/ benefits that Americans get for example unemployment insurance, social security, and pensions. To Russians, social programs like these would be unheard of, their society would think of these as absolutely insane, and their ideology would be that nothing is guaranteed to be offered to the common people if they fail. To Americans it is the very values that make Americans what they are. Lastly social equality would also be a shock to Russians, the fact that no one is forced to accept bad working conditions, there are unions, the people can directly negotiate with their employers, they strive for equal opportunity, for all races and sexes would be very foreign to them.